between globalization, regime credibility and a return to history is unmistakable.

The real truth about this revival of nationalism is that it has actually been a very durable basis for organizing societies. At various times, it has defeated conflicting ideologies that appealed to both larger and narrower loyalties. Multinational empires struggled with nationalist sentiment and by and large, lost out. But national entities that encountered sub-national dissensions have usually won. Western imperialism was eventually undone by nationalist sentiments awakening in their former colonies. Communism was the next of the transnational ideologies on a global scale. This too eventually foundered when socialism acquired national characteristics. The schism between the USSR and China, and later between China and Vietnam, affirmed the enduring appeal of nationalism.

Faith-based movements have also attempted to cut across national divides. These may use causes like that of Palestine or be an effort for a specific purpose like Bosnia or Afghanistan. The rise of the Daesh-Islamic State is a refinement of this model. Being outcomes of high emotion and exceptional circumstances, nationalism eventually returns them to business as usual.

The globalization of our era represents yet another effort at transcending an entrenched organizational principle of modern politics. But because it rests on a deeper technology basis and stronger economic interests, its tension with nationalism will continue for the foreseeable future. Contestation between two such powerful rationalizations is not unnatural. So, rather than visualize either of them as an event, we should see them as currents of history.

Coming in different sizes and shapes, nationalism can be assertive, reactive or just expressive. The confident category reflects the real and psychological outcome of shifts in the world power hierarchy. It is represented by the rise of nations like China and India, of a continent like Asia and the consequent rebalancing of the global order. This is evident in both the content and tenor of international conversations. It is visible also in most major conferences and negotiations. In fact, the very perception of who are key world leaders and the newer formats for their gathering – such as G-20 or BRICS – underline this evolution. Not just that, the global